

The Program in Action

When you run *snailrace.py*, the output will look like this:

Snail Race, by Al Sweigart al@inventwithpython.com

```
@v <-- snail

How many snails will race? Max: 8
> 3
Enter snail #1's name:
> Alice
Enter snail #2's name:
> Bob
Enter snail #3's name:
> Carol
START                                FINISH
|                                   |
      Alice
.....@v
      Bob
.....@v
      Carol
.....@v
--snip--
```

How It Works

This program makes use of two data structures, stored in two variables: `snailNames` is a list of strings of each snail's name, and `snailProgress` is a dictionary whose keys are the snails' names and whose values are integers representing how many spaces the snails have moved. Lines 79 to 82 read the data in these two variables to draw the snails at appropriate places on the screen.

```
1. """Snail Race, by Al Sweigart al@inventwithpython.com
2. Fast-paced snail racing action!
3. View this code at https://nostarch.com/big-book-small-python-projects
4. Tags: short, artistic, beginner, game, multiplayer"""
5.
6. import random, time, sys
7.
8. # Set up the constants:
9. MAX_NUM_SNAILS = 8
10. MAX_NAME_LENGTH = 20
11. FINISH_LINE = 40 # (!) Try modifying this number.
12.
13. print('''Snail Race, by Al Sweigart al@inventwithpython.com
14.
15.     @v <-- snail
16.
17. ''')
18.
```